Development Goals Index, India Innovation Index and Export Competitiveness Index. The NITI Aayog also releases delta rankings for the performance of Aspirational Districts every month.

The ranking of States in various social sectors based on quantitative objective criteria encourages them, and even districts, to improve their performance. The NITI Aayog works closely with all stakeholders, including the State/UT Governments, concerned Ministries/Departments in developing indicator frameworks, review mechanisms and capacity-building.

Autonomous And Attached Bodies

The NITI Aayog is supported by an autonomous body i.e., the National Institute of Labor Economics Research and Development and an attached office i.e., the Development Monitoring and Evaluation Organisation. These are explained below:

National Institute of Labour Economics Research and Development[10] The National Institute of Labour Economics Research and Development (NILERD) was formerly known as the Institute of Applied Manpower Research (IAMR). It is a central autonomous organization under the NITI Aayog. Its primary objectives are research, data collection, education and training in all aspects of human capital planning, human resource development, and monitoring and evaluation.

The IAMR was established in 1962 under the Societies Registration Act of 1860 as an institution that would function as a clearing-house of ideas and undertake policy research on human capital development to inform perspective planning and promote policy integration.

The IAMR has been renamed as NILERD in 2014. The NILERD is mainly funded by grants-in-aid from the NITI Aayog (formerly Planning Commission), and supplemented by its own revenue from contracted research projects, and education and training activities.

The Institute moved to its own campus at Narela in 2002. Narela is a developing urban and institutional hub declared as a special economic zone for knowledge in the National Capital Region.

Development Monitoring and Evaluation Office[11]**:** The need for an efficient and independent evaluation mechanism in India was recognized by the planners and policy-makers right from the introduction of planning process in the country and resultantly, the Programme Evaluation Organization was established by the Government in 1952 to carry out independent and objective impact evaluation of the Central Government funded programmes.

In an effort to accord more functional autonomy to the programme evaluation mechanism in the country, the Government established the Independent Evaluation Office in 2010.

The Development Monitoring and Evaluation Office (DMEO) was established by the Government in 2015 as an attached office of the NITI Aayog by merging the erstwhile Programme Evaluation Organization and the Independent Evaluation Office.

As the apex monitoring and evaluation office in the country, the DMEO supports the Government to achieve the national development agenda through monitoring and evaluation of government policies and programs. Since its inception in 2015, the office aims to support rigorous, data-driven, citizen-centric, and outcomes-driven program management and policymaking.

The DMEO's mandate involves: